

Specialty Rental Operating Benchmark

Two-page source brief | Four operating archetypes | Analysis date: July 18, 2026

SUBVERTICAL THESIS

Specialty rental splits into four economically distinct models: consumer-led delivered portable storage, B2B portable/mobile storage, modular space and temporary classrooms/offices, and trench-safety equipment. A narrow combined central envelope - about 5% growth, 34% EBITDA margin, 7% maintenance capex, 79% post-maintenance conversion and 4.8-year payback - is directionally useful but inferior to the archetype ranges. Standard B2B containers have the cleanest recurring rent, longest asset lives and strongest cash conversion. Modular units stay installed longer but cost more to deliver and refurbish. Trench safety is short-duration and project-sensitive but safety-critical. PODS overlays consumer acquisition, moving logistics, routes and yards. Reliant Rental remains unresolved and is excluded from benchmark weighting.

METRIC	BENCHMARK RANGE	WHY THE ASSERTION MAKES SENSE	STRONGEST SUPPORT / CAVEAT
Revenue growth	Consumer storage 1% / 4% / 7%; B2B storage 2% / 5% / 8%; Modular 3% / 6% / 9%; Trench 3% / 6% / 10%.	Growth is rate, units on rent and fleet additions: home moves for PODS, local availability for containers, project pipelines for modular and utility work for trench.	Mobile Mini's 2019 Storage Solutions rental revenue grew 4.0% and yield 3.5%; Modulaire reported more units on rent and 5% revenue-per-unit growth in 1Q22; TPRC had reached 37 branches and 5,000+ customers by 2021. Confidence: High for B2B storage and modular; Medium for trench safety; Low for consumer storage.
EBITDA margin	Consumer storage 28% / 33% / 38%; B2B storage 33% / 40% / 44%; Modular 28% / 34% / 38%; Trench 28% / 33% / 38%.	Simple steel containers maximize margin. Modular adds installation; trench adds branch, engineering and hauling cost; PODS bears delivery, yards and linehaul.	Mobile Mini disclosed a 41.0% Storage Solutions adjusted EBITDA margin in 2019. Modulaire reported EUR116 million EBITDA on EUR370 million revenue in 1Q22, just over 31%. PODS showed operating leverage when Q3 2024 sales fell 7.5% and EBITDA fell 24%. Confidence: High for B2B storage and modular; Medium for trench; Low for PODS.
Maintenance capex / revenue	Consumer storage 5% / 7% / 9%; B2B storage 4% / 6% / 8%; Modular 6% / 8% / 11%; Trench 5% / 7% / 10%.	Containers have long lives and high residuals; PODS also sustains delivery equipment, yards and systems. Modular requires refurbishment and resets. Trench fleets need inspection, repair, replacement and handling gear despite durable steel assets.	Mobile Mini assets had 30-year lives and 55% residuals. McGrath uses 18 years/50% for modular and 25 years/62.5% for storage. Ranges are inferred from replacement cycles. Confidence: Medium except Low for PODS; gross-versus-net replacement remains an important diligence gap.
Post-maintenance capex conversion	Consumer storage 68% / 79% / 87%; B2B storage 76% / 85% / 91%; Modular 61% / 76% / 84%; Trench 64% / 79% / 87%.	The calculation is (EBITDA minus maintenance capex) / EBITDA, before interest, tax, working capital and growth capex. B2B containers convert best because margins are high and sustaining fleet needs modest; modular gives up more cash to refurbishment.	Every range is calculated from the report's normalized margin and maintenance-capex assumptions rather than reported free cash flow. Confidence: Medium; Low for PODS because both input assumptions are lower-confidence.
Initial contract tenor	Consumer storage 1 / 1 / 3 months; B2B storage 1 / 3 / 12 months; Modular 12 / 18 / 36 months; Trench 1 week / 2 months / 6 months.	Consumer moves and trench phases need flexibility; commercial containers are month-based but extend. Installed modular space stays through school years or project phases, creating the longest initial terms.	PODS markets flexible monthly use; Mobile Mini used month-based rentals; McGrath states 1-12 months for storage and 12-24 months for modular; General Finance reported a typical lease averaging more than 12 months. Confidence: High for modular; Medium for the other archetypes.
Effective customer tenure	Consumer storage 3 / 8 / 18 months; B2B storage 2 / 4 / 7 years; Modular 4 / 7 / 10 years; Trench 3 / 5 / 8 years.	PODS tenure ends with the move or renovation. Commercial contractors, schools, institutions and utilities return across projects, so customer life materially exceeds any one unit's rental duration.	Mobile Mini served about 74,000 customers with low concentration; Modulaire serves 52,000+ customers; TPRC served 5,000+ customers. The report infers relationship tenure from repeat-account structures rather than disclosed churn cohorts. Confidence: Medium except Low for PODS.
Utilization exposure	Consumer storage Moderate / Moderate-to-High / High; B2B storage Moderate / Moderate / High; Modular Moderate / Moderate / Moderate-to-High; Trench Moderate-to-High / High / High.	Idle fleet earns no rent. Containers redeploy readily; modular units face installation and removal friction; trench inventory rolls off with project completion. PODS adds route and yard utilization to loaded-container exposure.	Mobile Mini's 2019 utilization was 79.1% by units and 77.9% by original cost; Modulaire reported 86% in 1Q22; McGrath's 2025 utilization was 73.0% for Mobile Modular and 60.8% for Portable Storage. Confidence: High for B2B storage and modular; Medium for trench; Low for PODS.
New-unit / customer payback	Consumer storage 2.5 / 3.5 / 5.0 years; B2B storage 3.5 / 4.5 / 6.0; Modular 4.5 / 6.0 / 8.0; Trench 2.5 / 3.5 / 5.0.	Cash payback reserves delivery, service and maintenance. Containers and trench steel have residual value; modular costs more; PODS needs rent plus move-event profit.	General Finance said revenue could recover original equipment cost within four years, but the report extends cash payback after direct costs. McGrath storage rents at 2%-4% of original cost monthly; long lives and residuals support downside value. Confidence: Medium; Low for PODS. All ranges are triangulated rather than direct cash-payback disclosures.
B2B versus B2C	Consumer storage Mixed / Mixed leaning B2C / Mixed; B2B storage, Modular and Trench: predominantly B2B.	PODS materially serves households whose event-driven demand creates shorter tenure and more acquisition cost. Other archetypes contract mainly with contractors, commercial and industrial users, schools, government, institutions and utilities.	Company disclosures identify PODS as residential and commercial; Mobile Mini's account structure was commercial; Modulaire and McGrath emphasize institutional/enterprise markets; TPRC served contractors and utilities. Confidence: High for the three B2B archetypes; Medium for PODS's exact mix.

HOW TO READ THE UNIVERSE

Seven designated names yield four usable archetypes. Mobile Mini is the clearest B2B storage reference; Modulaire and McGrath support modular; TPRC anchors trench safety; PODS is the consumer-led delivered-storage exception. General Finance bridges storage and modular but has mixed assets and sales. Reliant Rental is an identity exception, not a benchmark input. Acquired companies use their last reliable standalone periods.

PODS

What it does. Delivers containers for residential and commercial moving/storage.
Economic model. Unit: container-month plus move event; revenue is rent and logistics fees. Customers solve moves or renovations. PODS runs drivers, yards and linehaul; life-event completion causes churn. Container and delivery assets require capital.
Evidence bridge. 2m+ long-distance moves and 7m+ deliveries. Q3 2024 sales fell 7.5%, EBITDA 24%; ranges are Low confidence.

Mobile Mini

What it does. Rented storage containers and ground-level offices to commercial users.
Economic model. Unit: box on rent; revenue was mostly rental. Branches deliver and refurbish simple assets solving temporary jobsite needs. Projects end placements, but accounts repeat. Long lives and residuals limit capital needs.
Evidence bridge. 2019 standalone: \$490.7m Storage revenue, 41.0% margin, 79.1% unit utilization; assets had 30-year lives and 55% residuals.

Trench Plate Rental

What it does. Rented trench plates, shoring and safety systems to contractors and utilities.
Economic model. Unit: jobsite equipment set; revenue is rental/support. Branches solve mandatory excavation safety, then inspect and redeploy steel. Projects end rentals, but contractors repeat. Residual value helps capital recovery; project timing drives utilization.
Evidence bridge. Pre-2021 merger: 37 branches and 5,000+ customers. Financial ranges are Medium-confidence triangulations.

General Finance Corporation

What it does. Rented containers, mobile offices and modular units through regional brands.
Economic model. Unit: fleet asset; revenue is lease plus sales. Customers need temporary space. GFC delivered, maintained and re-leased units; projects cause churn, while accounts repeat. Long lives/residuals support capital recovery; mixed assets dilute margins.
Evidence bridge. FY2020: \$164.7m North America and \$63.1m Asia-Pacific leasing revenue; 70%-85% utilization, 20-30-year lives, residuals up to 70%.

Modulaire Group

What it does. Rents and installs modular space for public, infrastructure and enterprise users.
Economic model. Unit: module on rent; revenue is lease/service. Customers need temporary space. Modulaire transports, installs and refurbishes units; installation and repeat projects support retention. Resets and yards raise capital needs versus containers.
Evidence bridge. 330,000 units, 52,000+ customers. 1Q22: EUR370m revenue, EUR116m EBITDA, 86% utilization; capex precision is weaker.

McGrath RentCorp

What it does. Rents modular buildings and storage containers to businesses and institutions.
Economic model. Unit: module/container; revenue is rent plus delivery/service. Customers need classrooms, jobsite space or storage. McGrath installs and refurbishes; repeat accounts outlast placements. Strong residuals limit replacement, though modular resets consume capital.
Evidence bridge. 2025: modular utilization 73.0%, storage 60.8%. Lives/residuals: modular 18 years/50%; storage 25 years/62.5%.

Reliant Rental

What it does. No standalone specialty-rental operator is resolved; evidence points only to a Vander/BlueLine brand candidate.
Economic model. Unavailable: no supported asset, unit, revenue, customer, operating, capital or churn model. BlueLine economics cannot be substituted.
Evidence bridge. A 2014 trademark links Reliant to Vander; BlueLine sold in 2018. All metrics are Unavailable, Low confidence and unweighted.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

Keep the four archetypes separate: asset standardization and service intensity are the largest sources of economic variation. | Use gross replacement and refurbishment requirements, not depreciation or net capex alone, to assess sustaining capital. | Track physical and dollar utilization with consistent denominators; delivery, yard and branch utilization can matter as much as units on rent. | Separate unit rental duration from repeat-account life; short monthly or job-phase contracts can coexist with multi-year customer tenure. | Resolve Reliant Rental's exact legal and operating identity before assigning any metric or including it in a benchmark.